

ARTEX FINANCE CAMPAIGN

Connections to source-documented proxy and ARTEX infrastructure

HUNTING / MEDIUM CONFIDENCE



MICROSOFT DEFENDER XDR



T1090 · IOC-BASED



Published 08 October 2026



EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision

- CrowdStrike identified infrastructure associated with intrusions against South Korean financial organizations.

- Nine addresses were observed as proxies; 38.244.50.120 hosted an ARTEX instance and an exposed Claude configuration.

- The indicators are directly observed but time-bounded and potentially reassignable. Classification remains Hunting.

- Operational value: 6/10. Treat every match as an investigative lead, never as proof of compromise.

CAMPAIGN EVIDENCE

Observed infrastructure

Campaign activity occurred from late September to early October 2026.

Open directories exposed Claude Code session histories, ARTEX configuration files and memory files.

CrowdStrike reported a two-server architecture and multiple proxy addresses used during ARTEX activity.

The source does not expose the exploited vulnerabilities or a victim-side execution pattern.

Attribution remains unnamed; Chinese-speaking and financially motivated are vendor assessments at moderate confidence.

TELEMETRY CONTRACT

Required evidence

Required: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint network connection telemetry in DeviceNetworkEvents.



Documented fields: Timestamp, DeviceName, RemoteIP, RemotePort, Protocol, RemoteUrl and initiating-process details.



Optional enrichment: asset criticality, process reputation, DNS, proxy, firewall and incident-response evidence.



Unavailable: network content, exploit proof, ARTEX execution and data exfiltration are not inferred by this query.



HUNTING LOGIC

Primary IOC query

```
let ArtexInfrastructure = dynamic([10 source-documented IP addresses]);
```

```
DeviceNetworkEvents
```

```
| where RemoteIP in (ArtexInfrastructure)
```

```
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, RemoteIP, RemotePort, Protocol,
```

```
RemoteUrl, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
```

```
InitiatingProcessSHA1, InitiatingProcessAccountUpn, ReportId
```

```
| order by Timestamp desc
```

TRIAGE

Investigation path

Confirm directionality: RemoteIP represents the destination connected to by the endpoint.



Identify the initiating process, signer, hash, user, device role and complete process lineage.



Check DNS, proxy and firewall records for the same destination and adjacent communications.



Determine whether the address was reassigned or used by legitimate shared hosting at event time.



Escalate only when endpoint context or additional evidence supports unauthorized activity.



FALSE POSITIVES & VALIDATION

Promotion gates

- Possible overlap: reassigned infrastructure, shared hosting, VPN/proxy services or security research.

- Do not suppress solely by IP owner; preserve event-time context and initiating-process evidence.

- Success: controlled network telemetry populates RemoteIP and initiating-process fields consistently.

- Reject: indicators generate benign shared-service traffic or cannot be tied to the reported period.

- Failure: outbound connections are not collected, RemoteIP is rewritten, or traffic bypasses the endpoint sensor.

CONCLUSION & REFERENCES

Analytical conclusion

- This hunt operationalizes direct infrastructure evidence without converting an IOC into a behavioral detection.

- It does not claim ARTEX execution, vulnerability exploitation, data theft, compromise or attribution.

- Primary: CrowdStrike, Unknown Threat Actor Uses AI-Driven ARTEX to Target South Korean Finance, 2026-10-07.

- Schema: Microsoft Learn, DeviceNetworkEvents, accessed 2026-10-08.

- ATT&CK: T1090 Proxy.

- Status: Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch.